

# Vegetables

The word “vegetable” is not a scientific term. It is a word that people began to use hundreds of years ago to refer to plants that were grown to eat, rather than foraged from the wild. There are many different types, and they are rich in vitamins and minerals.

## TYPES OF VEGETABLES

Vegetables are divided into groups according to the part of the plant that is eaten, for example roots, stems, leaves, pods, or flowers. Some are strictly “fruits”, but because they are used in savoury cooking, are commonly called vegetables.



FRUIT



POD VEGETABLES



LEAFY VEGETABLES



FLOWERS AND BUDS



ROOT VEGETABLES



BULBS AND STEMS

## COLOURS

You can often tell the health benefits of a vegetable from its colour. The colours of vegetables come from their natural pigments.



**CHLOROPHYLL**  
Helps replenish red blood cells in the body.



**CAROTENOIDS**  
Convert to vitamin A, which is good for eye health.



**ANTHOCYANINS**  
Help protect the body's cells from damage.



**LYCOPENE**  
Protects body cells and may reduce the risk of cancer.

## POD VEGETABLES

Pod vegetables come from plants that produce fruits in the form of seeds or beans, nestled inside a pod. Many pod vegetables belong to a family of vegetables known as legumes. These vegetables are very high in protein.



OKRA



BROAD BEANS

## LEAFY VEGETABLES

All vegetables have leaves, but “leafy vegetables” are the ones where we eat the leaves, rather than trim them off. The darker the leaves, the stronger the taste, and the richer they are in vitamins A and C and bone-strengthening calcium.



CABBAGE



AMARANTH



BRUSSELS SPROUTS



RED CABBAGE



SALAD ROCKET



BOK CHOY



CHICKWEED

## FRUIT

These vegetables are all the fruit of a plant, and they contain the seeds it would use to reproduce. In this sense, they are very like apples and oranges, but these fruits contain less sugar and taste savoury, not sweet.



PEPPER



RED CHILLI



SQUASH



GOURD



BUTTERNUT SQUASH



MARROW



AUBERGINE



COURGETTE



PUMPKIN

## FLOWERS AND BUDS

These vegetables are taken from plants that are grown for their edible flower heads or buds, such as broccoli and cauliflower. They are sturdy and high in fibre, which is good for the digestive system.



CAULIFLOWER



ARTICHOKE



BROCCOLI



DI SICILIA VIOLETTA  
CAULIFLOWER



ROMANESCO  
CAULIFLOWER



WATER CHESTNUT



SWEDE



PARSNIP



RADISH

**“BROCCOLI” IS AN ITALIAN WORD THAT MEANS “LITTLE SPROUTS” OR “LITTLE SHOOTS”**